

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 31 and 32

The Murakkab Isharee and the Murakkab Idafi in the Jumla Ismiyyah

1. A recap of the Jumla Ismiyyah

A construction of two or more words from which the sense is completed is called a *Murakkab Tamm*, and it is also called a *Jumlah*. A sentence is of two kinds: the *Jumla Ismiyyah*, which begins with an *Ism*, and the *Jumla Fi'liyyah*, which begins with a *Fi'l*.

Aspect	Rule	How strictly it holds
Wus'at	the Muftada comes as Ma'rifah while the Khabar comes as Nakirah	99 percent
I'raab	both the Muftada and the Khabar come as Marfoo'	100 percent
Jins and 'Adad	there is agreement between the Muftada and the Khabar	99.99 percent

In Arabic the sense of "is" arises from the joining of a *Ma'rifah* with a *Nakirah*. The *Muftada* and the *Khabar* are alike in three respects and differ only in *wus'at*.

2. The Murakkab Isharee in the Jumla Ismiyyah

A *Murakkab Isharee* is made up of two parts: the *Ism ul Isharah*, the word that points, and the *Mushar Ilayh*, the noun pointed at.

The rules of the Murakkab Isharee

- The *Mushar Ilayh* must be a *Ma'rifah* carrying al-.
- A *Murakkab Isharee* forms only a *Ma'rifah* construction; it never forms a *Nakirah* one.
- The *I'raab* of a *Murakkab Isharee* is settled by the *I'raab* of the *Mushar Ilayh*.
- The singular and plural *Asma' ul Isharah* are *Mabni* — one form in *raf'*, *nasb* and *jarr*.
- The dual *Asma' ul Isharah* are *Mu'rab* — one form for *raf'* and another for *nasb* and *jarr*.

The table of the Asma' ul Isharah

Kind	Wahid	Tathniyah — raf'	Tathniyah — nasb & jarr	Jam'
Mudhakkar, near	هَذَا	هَذَانِ	هَٰذَيْنِ	هَٰؤُلَاءِ
Mu'annath, near	هَذِهِ	هَٰتَانِ	هَٰتَيْنِ	هَٰؤُلَاءِ
Mudhakkar, far	ذَلِكَ	ذَٰلِكَ	ذَٰئِكَ	أُولَٰئِكَ
Mu'annath, far	تِلْكَ	تَٰذِكَ	تَٰئِكَ	أُولَٰئِكَ

3. The Murakkab Isharee as Muftada

An important rule: A *Murakkab Isharee* is always *Ma'rifah*, so it can stand **only** in the place of the *Muftada*, never in the place of the *Khabar*.

3.1 With the near Asma' ul Isharah

The sentence	Translation
هَذَا الْوَلَدُ صَالِحٌ	this boy is righteous
هَذَانِ الْوَلَدَانِ صَالِحَانِ	these two boys are righteous
هَؤُلَاءِ الْوُلَدُ صَالِحُونَ	these boys are righteous
هَذِهِ الْبِنْتُ صَالِحَةٌ	this girl is righteous
هَاتَانِ الْبَنَتَانِ صَالِحَتَانِ	these two girls are righteous
هَؤُلَاءِ الْبَنَاتُ صَالِحَاتُ	these girls are righteous

An analysis of the first example: هَذَا الْوَلَدُ is a *Murakkab Isharee* standing as the *Muftada*, and صَالِحٌ is a *mufrad Khabar*.

3.2 With the far Asma' ul Isharah

The sentence	Translation
ذَلِكَ الْوَلَدُ صَالِحٌ	that boy is righteous
ذَٰلِكَ الْوَلَدَانِ صَالِحَانِ	those two boys are righteous
أُولَٰئِكَ الْوُلَدُ صَالِحُونَ	those boys are righteous
تِلْكَ الْبِنْتُ صَالِحَةٌ	that girl is righteous
تَٰلِكَ الْبَنَتَانِ صَالِحَتَانِ	those two girls are righteous
أُولَٰئِكَ الْبَنَاتُ صَالِحَاتُ	those girls are righteous

4. A most important distinction

What comes immediately after the *Ism ul Isharah* is what settles whether the *Ism ul Isharah* is the *Muftada* by itself, or whether it joins the next word to form a construction.

The deciding rule: If a noun carrying **al-** comes immediately after هَذَا, the two together form a **Murakkab Isharee** and that is the **Mubtada**. And if **no noun with al-** follows, then هَذَا alone becomes the **Mubtada** and what follows is the **Khabar**.

The sentence	Mubtada	Khabar	Translation
هَذَا الْكِتَابُ جَدِيدٌ	هَذَا الْكِتَابُ — Murakkab Isharee	جَدِيدٌ — mufrad	this book is new
هَذَا كِتَابٌ جَدِيدٌ	هَذَا — mufrad	كِتَابٌ جَدِيدٌ — Murakkab Tawsifi	this is a new book
هَذَا كِتَابُ زَيْدٍ	هَذَا — mufrad	كِتَابُ زَيْدٍ — Murakkab Idafi	this is Zayd's book

The effect on the translation: The words in the first and second examples are nearly the same, yet the translation changes entirely: "this book is new" against "this is a new book". The whole difference is the **alif lam**.

5. The sixth category of the Ma'rifah — Ma'rifah bil Idafah

Five categories of the *Ma'rifah* have already been studied: the *Ism ul 'Alam*, the *Ism ud Dameer*, the *Ism ul Isharah*, the *Ism ul Mawsul* and the *Mu'arraḥ bil Lam*.

The sixth category: When a *Nakirah* noun is annexed to a *Ma'rifah* noun — that is, related to it — that *Nakirah* too becomes *Ma'rifah*. This is called *Ma'rifah bil Idafah*.

وَلَدُ زَيْدٍ

(Zayd's son)

The *Nakirah* noun وَلَدُ was related to زَيْدٍ, which is *Ma'rifah* for being an *Ism ul 'Alam*. The whole construction has therefore become *Ma'rifah*.

6. The Murakkab Idafi in the Jumla Ismiyyah

مضاف + مضاف اليه = مركب اضافي

The rules of the Murakkab Idafi

- The *I'raab* is always recognised by the *Mudaf*.
- The *I'raab* of the *Mudaf* may be any of the three — *raf'*, *nasb* or *jarr*.
- The *I'raab* of the *Mudaf Ilayh* is always *jarr*.
- *alif lam* never comes upon the *Mudaf*.
- If the *Mudaf Ilayh* is *Ma'rifah* the whole construction is *Ma'rifah*; if it is *Nakirah* the whole is *Nakirah*.

6.1 As Mubtada — masculine

If the *Mudaf Ilayh* is *Ma'rifah* the whole construction becomes *Ma'rifah*, and so it will stand in the place of the *Mubtada*.

The sentence	Translation
وَلَدُ زَيْدٍ صَالِحٌ	Zayd's son is righteous
وَلَدَا زَيْدٍ صَالِحَانِ	Zayd's two sons are righteous
أَوْلَادُ زَيْدٍ صَالِحُونَ	Zayd's sons are righteous

The dropping of the noon: A dual noun drops its noon when it becomes a *Mudaf*: وَلَدَانِ gives وَلَدَا. This rule was covered in detail in Lecture 23.

6.2 As Muftada — feminine

The sentence	Translation
بِنْتُ زَيْدٍ صَالِحَةٌ	Zayd's daughter is righteous
بَنَاتُ زَيْدٍ صَالِحَتَانِ	Zayd's two daughters are righteous
بَنَاتُ زَيْدٍ صَالِحَاتُ	Zayd's daughters are righteous

6.3 An Ism ul Isharah as the Mudaf Ilayh

The *Mudaf Ilayh* is not only an *Ism ul 'Alam*; an *Ism ul Isharah* may also become the *Mudaf Ilayh*, since it too is *Ma'rifah*.

The sentence	Translation
وَلَدُ ذَاكَ صَالِحٌ	his son is righteous
أَوْلَادُ أُولَئِكَ صَالِحُونَ	their sons are righteous
بِنْتُ تِلْكَ صَالِحَةٌ	her daughter is righteous
بَنَاتُ أُولَئِكَ صَالِحَاتُ	their daughters are righteous

7. The Murakkab Idafi as Khabar

A *Murakkab Idafi* may also stand in the place of the *Khabar*, and it is this that sets it apart from the *Murakkab Isharee*.

7.1 Masculine

The sentence	Translation
أَسَامَةُ وَلَدُ زَيْدٍ	Usamah is Zayd's son
أَسَامَةُ وَطَلْحَةُ وَلَدَا زَيْدٍ	Usamah and Talhah are Zayd's two sons
أَسَامَةُ وَطَلْحَةُ وَحَمْرَةُ أَوْلَادُ زَيْدٍ	Usamah, Talhah and Hamzah are Zayd's sons

7.2 Feminine

The sentence	Translation
زَيْنَبُ بِنْتُ زَيْدٍ	Zaynab is Zayd's daughter
زَيْنَبُ وَمَرْيَمُ بَنَتَا زَيْدٍ	Zaynab and Maryam are Zayd's two daughters
زَيْنَبُ وَمَرْيَمُ وَفَاطِمَةُ بَنَاتُ زَيْدٍ	Zaynab, Maryam and Fatimah are Zayd's daughters

A necessary clarification

In these examples the *Mudaf Ilayh* زَيْدٍ is an *Ism ul 'Alam*, that is, *Ma'rifah*. So the whole *Murakkab Idafi* is *Ma'rifah* too, and here a *Ma'rifah* has come in the place of the *Khabar*.

This is that one percent: It was stated at the outset that the condition of the *Mubtada* being *Ma'rifah* and the *Khabar Nakirah* holds in 99 percent of cases. This is the remaining one percent. When the purpose of the sentence is **identification** — that is, to state who someone is — the *Khabar* may also be *Ma'rifah*.

This is why أَسَامَةُ وَلَدُ زَيْدٍ means "Usamah is Zayd's son", that is, Usamah is being identified. In such a case the first noun is reckoned the *Mubtada* and the second the *Khabar*.

8. Two constructions in one sentence

The summary: Three constructions can stand in the place of the *Mubtada*: the *Tawsifi*, the *Idafi* and the *Isharee*. Two can stand in the place of the *Khabar*: the *Tawsifi* and the *Idafi*.

Why can a Murakkab Isharee not be the Khabar?: Because a *Murakkab Isharee* is always *Ma'rifah*, whereas the general rule for the *Khabar* is that it be *Nakirah*.

An example

وَلَدٌ صَالِحٌ	زَيْدٌ
Khabar (Murakkab Tawsifi)	Mubtada (mufrad)

Translation: Zayd is a righteous boy.

9. Analyses from the Qur'an and hadith

9.1 Muhammadun Rasulallah

رَسُولُ اللَّهِ	مُحَمَّدٌ
Khabar (Murakkab Idafi)	Mubtada (mufrad)

Translation: Muhammad, peace be upon him, is the Messenger of Allah.

This sentence is made up of three nouns. مُحَمَّدٌ is *mufrad*, *Marfoo'* and *Ma'rifah*; this is the *Mubtada*. And رَسُولُ اللَّهِ is a *Murakkab Idafi*, in which رَسُولٌ is the *Mudaf* and اللَّهِ the *Mudaf Ilayh* — it has been used in the place of the *Khabar*.

9.2 Allahu Rabbul 'Alameen

رَبُّ الْعَالَمِينَ	اللَّهُ
Khabar (Murakkab Idafi)	Mubtada (mufrad)

Translation: Allah is the Lord of all the worlds.

9.3 Allahu Maliku Yawmid-Deen

مَالِكُ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ	اللَّهُ
Khabar (complex Murakkab Idafi)	Mubtada (mufrad)

Translation: Allah is the Master of the Day of Recompense.

Here the *Khabar* is built of two *Murakkab Idafi* joined: مَالِكُ and يَوْمِ الدِّينِ. And يَوْمِ الدِّينِ is itself a complete *Murakkab Idafi*. That is why it is called a complex *Murakkab Idafi*, the detail of which was given in Lecture 24.

9.4 Reflection on a hadith

الدُّنْيَا سِجْنُ الْمُؤْمِنِ وَجَنَّةُ الْكَافِرِ

Translation: The world is a prison for the believer and a paradise for the disbeliever.

Element	Details
الدُّنْيَا	the Mubtada — mufrad and a Ma'rifah carrying al-. Since the al- is at the beginning, it is not a Mudaf
سِجْنُ الْمُؤْمِنِ	the Khabar — a Murakkab Idafi, in which سِجْنُ is the Mudaf and الْمُؤْمِنِ the Mudaf Ilayh
وَجَنَّةُ الْكَافِرِ	a second Murakkab Idafi joined by the Waw ul 'Atf, coupled to the first Khabar

An excellent test: The word **الدُّنْيَا** carries *alif lam*, and *alif lam* never comes upon a *Mudaf*. By that one mark it is known at once that this is not a *Mudaf* but the *Mubtada* standing alone.

9.5 Surah Al 'Imran, verse 185

كُلُّ نَفْسٍ ذَائِقَةُ الْمَوْتِ

Translation: Every soul will taste death.

Element	Details
كُلُّ نَفْسٍ	a Murakkab Idafi, in which كُلُّ is the Mudaf and نَفْسٍ the Mudaf Ilayh. It stands in the place of the Mubtada
ذَائِقَةُ الْمَوْتِ	a Murakkab Idafi, in which ذَائِقَةُ is the Mudaf and الْمَوْتِ the Mudaf Ilayh. It stands in the place of the Khabar

In this verse both the *Mubtada* and the *Khabar* are a *Murakkab Idafi*. And because a *Nakirah* noun follows **كُلُّ**, it is rendered "every", as was seen in Lecture 26.

10. An easy formula for translation

The easy way: Bring the English rendering to mind. What comes before is / are / am will be the *Mubtada*, and what comes after it the *Khabar*.

Arabic	Translation	Kind of Khabar
اللَّهُ رَبُّنَا	Allah is our Lord	Murakkab Idafi
هُوَ خَالِقُنَا	He is our Creator	Murakkab Idafi
نَحْنُ عِبِيدُهُ	we are His servants	Murakkab Idafi
نَحْنُ مُسْلِمُونَ	we are Muslims	mufrad
الْإِسْلَامُ دِينُنَا	Islam is our religion	Murakkab Idafi
مُحَمَّدٌ نَبِيُّنَا	Muhammad, peace be upon him, is our Prophet	Murakkab Idafi

In these examples the *Mudaf Ilayh* is a pronoun, as in **رَبُّنَا** and **عِبِيدُهُ**. A pronoun too is *Ma'rifah*, so the whole construction becomes *Ma'rifah*.

11. Further examples of the complex Murakkab Idafi

The sentence	Translation
هُوَ ابْنُ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ	he is the son of 'Abdullah
فَاطِمَةُ وَزَيْنَبُ ابْنَتَا النَّبِيِّ	Fatimah and Zaynab, may Allah be pleased with them, are the daughters of the Prophet
أَبُو بَكْرٍ وَعُمَرُ حَمَوَا النَّبِيِّ	Abu Bakr and 'Umar, may Allah be pleased with them, are the fathers-in-law of the Prophet
عُثْمَانُ وَعَلِيٌّ خَتَنَا النَّبِيِّ	'Uthman and 'Ali, may Allah be pleased with them, are the sons-in-law of the Prophet

The noon drops in all three: A dual noun drops its noon when it becomes a *Mudaf*: ابْنَتَانِ gives ابْنَتَا, حَمَوَانِ gives حَمَوَا, and خَتَنَانِ gives خَتَنَا.

The word **حَم** is one of the *Asma' Sittah*, and its dual has come as a *Mudaf* in the form **حَمَوَا**. Likewise the hamzah of **ابْن** is a *Hamzat ul Wasl*, which is why **هُوَ ابْنُ** is read joined.

Summary

1. A Murakkab Tamm is called a Jumlah, and a sentence is of two kinds: the Jumla Ismiyyah and the Jumla Fi'liyyah.
2. The Muftada is Ma'rifah and the Khabar Nakirah (99 percent), both are Marfoo' (100 percent), and they agree in gender and number (99.99 percent).
3. A Murakkab Isharee is made of two parts, the Ism ul Isharah and the Mushar Ilayh, and the Mushar Ilayh must be a Ma'rifah carrying al-.
4. A Murakkab Isharee forms only a Ma'rifah construction, which is why it can stand only as the Muftada and never as the Khabar.
5. The singular and plural Asma' ul Isharah are Mabni, and only the dual ones are Mu'rab.
6. If a noun carrying al- comes immediately after هَذَا, the two form a Murakkab Isharee and that is the Muftada.
7. And if no noun with al- follows, هَذَا alone becomes the Muftada and what follows is the Khabar.
8. هَذَا الْكِتَابُ جَدِيدٌ means "this book is new", while هَذَا كِتَابٌ جَدِيدٌ means "this is a new book".
9. The sixth category of the Ma'rifah is Ma'rifah bil Idafah: a Nakirah annexed to a Ma'rifah becomes Ma'rifah itself.
10. The I'raab of a Murakkab Idafi is recognised by the Mudaf, and the Mudaf Ilayh is always Majroor.
11. alif lam never comes upon the Mudaf.
12. If the Mudaf Ilayh is Ma'rifah the whole construction is Ma'rifah, and if Nakirah then the whole is Nakirah.
13. A dual noun drops its noon when it becomes a Mudaf: وَلَدَانِ gives وَلَدَا.
14. An Ism ul Isharah may also be the Mudaf Ilayh, as in وَلَدَ ذَلِكَ صَالِحٌ.
15. A Murakkab Idafi may stand as both Muftada and Khabar, and this is what sets it apart from the Murakkab Isharee.
16. In sentences like وَلَدَ زَيْدٌ أَسَامَةُ the Khabar is Ma'rifah; this is the remaining one percent of the rule of wus'at, and it occurs where the purpose is identification.
17. Three constructions can stand as the Muftada — Tawsifi, Idafi and Isharee — while two can stand as the Khabar: Tawsifi and Idafi.
18. In مُحَمَّدٌ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ the Muftada is mufrad and the Khabar a Murakkab Idafi.
19. In اللَّهُ مَا لَكَ يَوْمَ الدِّينِ the Khabar is a complex Murakkab Idafi, since يَوْمَ الدِّينِ is itself a Murakkab Idafi.
20. In the hadith أَلَدُنِّيَا سَجُنُ الْمُؤْمِنِ, the alif lam on أَلَدُنِّيَا shows at once that it is not a Mudaf but the Muftada standing alone.
21. In كُلُّ نَفْسٍ ذَاتِقَةٍ أَلَمَوْتِ both the Muftada and the Khabar are a Murakkab Idafi.
22. The easy formula is that what precedes "is" or "are" is the Muftada and what follows is the Khabar.
23. اِبْنَتَا, حَمَوَا and حَتَّنَا are all duals whose noon has dropped because they have become a Mudaf.

Exercise

1. Write all three rules of the Jumla Ismiyyah with how strictly each holds.
 2. Name both parts of a Murakkab Isharee and write all five of its rules.
 3. Set out the complete table of the Asma' ul Isharah.
 4. Why can a Murakkab Isharee not stand as the Khabar?
 5. Form six sentences each with the near and the far Asma' ul Isharah.
 6. Separate the Mubtada and the Khabar in هَذَا كِتَابٌ جَدِيدٌ and هَذَا الْكِتَابُ جَدِيدٌ.
 7. Which construction is the Khabar in هَذَا كِتَابٌ زَيْدٍ?
 8. Define Ma'rifah bil Idafah and give an example.
 9. Write all five rules of the Murakkab Idafi.
 10. Form three sentences each, masculine and feminine, with بِنْتُ and وَلَدٌ.
 11. What change occurs when a dual noun becomes a Mudaf? Give three examples.
 12. Write four examples in which an Ism ul Isharah stands as the Mudaf Ilayh.
 13. In أَسَامَةُ وَلَدٌ زَيْدٍ the Khabar is Ma'rifah; under what rule is this sound?
 14. Which constructions can stand as the Mubtada and which as the Khabar?
 15. Give a full analysis of مُحَمَّدٌ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ.
 16. Why is the Khabar in اللَّهُ مَالِكُ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ called a complex Murakkab Idafi?
 17. Give the I'raab analysis of the hadith الدُّنْيَا سَجْنُ الْمُؤْمِنِ وَجَنَّةُ الْكَافِرِ.
 18. Separate the Mubtada and the Khabar in كُلُّ نَفْسٍ ذَائِقَةُ الْمَوْتِ and state the kind of each.
 19. Explain the easy formula for translation and give three examples.
 20. Why did the noon drop in حَمَوَا and حَتَّنَا, and to which group does حَم belong?
-

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ